ISABELLE ATHENA QIAN

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EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley Expected Graduation: Spring 2027

B.A. Computer Science (Honors) | *B.A.* Philosophy | *B.A.* German Studies | Minor in Public Policy

RESEARCH & TEACHING EXPERIENCE

UC Berkeley School of Information June 2025 – Present

Research Assistant to Professor Deirdre Mulligan Berkeley, CA

- Accepted Paper at AI for Law Scholars Conference 2026: Conducted a longitudinal audit of LLMs to evaluate their answers to legal questions, developed a benchmark based on court cases, and designed annotation schemas.
- Created a database evaluating California laws between 2024 and 2026 on regulating public sector agencies' use of AI.
- Tracked legal complaints and lawsuits against frontier developers to evaluate how tech defendants deploy claims of corporate compliance, safety benchmarking, and red-teaming disclaimers as legal defenses against negligence claims.
- Compiled 100+ AI governance policies across federal, state, and international jurisdictions to develop a comprehensive AI policy library under Eric Hysen, former Department of Homeland Security Chief AI Officer.
- Researched 30+ U.S. data infrastructures to build a field guide and promote cross-agency alignment of the language for understanding datasets under Denice Ross, former U.S. Chief Data Scientist.

UC Berkeley Department of Mathematics July 2024 – August 2026

Undergraduate Student Instructor Berkeley, CA

- Teach discussion sections of the "Foundations of Lower Division Mathematics" course (over Summer 2026, Fall 2024, Summer 2024), dedicating 20 hours weekly to helping students from diverse academic backgrounds.
- Instruct 13 pre-calculus topics, develop and adapt educational materials that foster critical thinking and problem-solving skills, preparing students for success in quantitative fields requiring strong analytical foundations.

GenAI Exercise in UC Berkeley Course "Brilliance of Berkeley" January 2026 – May 2026

- Designed a series of multi-modal generative AI learning exercises (e.g., text summary, infographic, notes) for a 20-student beta group within an 850+ student course to evaluate responsible student interaction with LLM outputs.
- Conducted interviews with participants across varied academic disciplines to integrate qualitative feedback into exercise iterations; final report available to download at https://ue.berkeley.edu/projects-initiatives/brilliance-berkeley.

Accepted Conference Paper: "A Decision-Theoretic Approach for Managing Misalignment" February 2026

- Co-authored a paper presented at the International Association for Safe and Ethical Artificial Intelligence Conference.
- Built a decision-theoretic framework optimizing autonomous agent delegation by balancing value alignment, epistemic accuracy, and behavioral reach; to read: https://virtual.oxfordabstracts.com/event/75968/submission/400.

CIVIC DEVOTION & COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

International Association for Safe and Ethical Artificial Intelligence (IASEAI) January 2026 – Present

Associate Project Manager

- Coordinate on-site logistics and participant communications for IASEAI'26 Conference at the Paris UNESCO House.
- Managed attendance and facilitation of 12+ workshops for IASEAI'26 Workshop Day and drafted playbook.
- Research community management principles across public technology forums to draft IASEAI's Code of Conduct and maintain the IASEAI content resource library.

Friends of the University March 2025 – Present

Volunteer Berkeley, CA

- Manage logistics and outreach for events, including a luncheon for CA State Senators and Assembly members, and UC Trustees; authored visual one-pagers and impact reports to communicate university data to state representatives.
- Build a strategic database mapping C-suite alumni and corporate lobbyists across the top 40 institutional employers to support corporate fundraising and university partnership initiatives.

Berkeley and San Francisco Mayoral Campaign Team June 2024 – November 2024

Campaign Intern San Francisco and Berkeley, CA

- Conducted voter demographic analyses using Excel and TargetSmartVAN; compiled weekly reports on voter trends.
- Supported campaign events by assisting in house parties, expanding the supporter base, and handling logistics.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Office of the UC Berkeley's Vice Provost for Undergraduate Education (VPUE) September 2024 – Present
Student Advisor Berkeley, CA

- Serve on the Student Advisory Council on Undergraduate Education, meeting monthly to advise on academic accommodations, campus resource navigation, and undergraduate student experience.
- Join VPUE's Educating in the Age of AI Working Group, shaping departmental AI strategy, course development, and cross-disciplinary dialogue series on responsible usage; co-authored "An Incoming UC Berkeley Undergraduate Student's Guide to AI", distributed to all students; available at: https://ai.berkeley.edu/guidance.

College of Computing, Data Science, and Society (CDSS) September 2024 – Present
First Year Mentor Berkeley, CA

- Mentor 10 first-year students navigating their curriculum; organize exam preparation sessions and mock tests.
- Organize cohort bonding sessions that allow students to explore the city: introducing them to my favorite local restaurants and leading free kayaking retreats to help form tight-knit friendships over their first year at college.
- Volunteered for CDSS's Fly-in Student Panel, sharing my college experiences with 48 rural and small-town Northern California counselors to expand college access awareness for prospective students.

Student Integrated Systems Executive Committee May 2025 – Present
Student Representative Berkeley, CA

- Serve as a student voice during monthly meetings by gathering student feedback to influence strategic decisions on digital infrastructure, service integration, and governance practices that shape the end-to-end student lifecycle.

Blackwell Hall Association September 2023 – May 2025
President Berkeley, CA

- Established and ensured smooth implementation of the agenda for allocating a $10K budget over one academic year.
- Fostered a strong sense of unity among 775 residents by organizing 10+ hall-wide social and educational programs (e.g., biweekly movie nights, Halloween Trick or Treat, SuperBowl Watch Party, and Valentine's Mailbox Run).

HONORS AND AWARDS

- **2026 Samuel Silver Memorial Scholarship** (UC Berkeley EECS Department): awarded to a single student who best combines intellectual achievement in science with serious humanistic and cultural interests.
- **Fall 2023-Spring 2026 Dean's List** (UC Berkeley College of Letters & Science and CDSS): awarded to top 10% of undergraduates every semester.
- **2026 Tenth Place Year-End High Point Rider**; **2025 Ninth Place Year-End High Point Rider** (USHJA/IHSA)
- **Fall 2025 Best First Year Mentor; Best Cohort** (UC Berkeley CDSS): awarded to one mentor and one group.
- **2024-25 Hall Association of the Year** (UC Berkeley Residence Hall Assembly): one team for top performance.
- **2024-25 Residential Life Vukasin Leadership Award** (UC Berkeley Residential Life Leadership): for building task-tracking systems and fostering a culture of collaboration, accountability, and program continuity.

HOBBIES AND INTERESTS

UC Berkeley Equestrian Team: Once a Horse Girl, Always a Horse Girl. 2023 – Present
Co-Captain (2025-Present), Competition Team Member (2024-Present), Social Team Member (2023-24)

- Lead team operations by developing sponsorship pipelines to support team finances and bolster team visibility.
- Train in weekly lesson groups and additional private lessons with a two-hour round-trip commute to the ranch.

Summer UC Berkeley Tour Guide: Proud Fourth Golden Bear of My Family. 2024 – Present

- Lead a campus tour for 30+ prospective students and parents every summer.

Avid Self-Taught Baker: Dreamed of waking up every day to the smell of bread! 2020 – Present

- Test and refine recipes of low-sugar Asian baked goods (e.g., shokupan and buns) for my diabetic grandmother.
- Bake a new dessert every week with my friend for our church small group evening fellowship during the school year.

Chinese Calligrapher: One of the Many Ways I Connect with My Cultural Roots. 2018 – Present
Calligraphic Styles: Seal Script, Ouyang Xun Regular Script

- Practice on my own as a screen-free leisure activity to improve concentration, body control, and patience.
- Hand-brush Chinese couplets as gifts for those I am grateful for during Lunar New Year, sharing my cultural heritage.

Languages: English (Native), Mandarin Chinese (Native), German (Professional Working)